

INT. COUNSELLOR'S OFFICE - DAY

A spacious room with desk in the centre. Two chairs on one side, and one chair on the other. A comfortable couch by the window.

MAX sits on the chair, holding a icepack to his lips, his shirt has drops of blood on it. His face is red.

LIAM sits on the couch, legs folded, he is sipping water. He eyes Max.

MISS PEPPER is by the door. She is fidgeting with an engagement ring on her finger.

LIAM (CONT'D)
(eying Max)
I mean you looked pretty ugly before
but now, Now you look hideous.

LIAM (CONT'D)
(smirks)
Bet you'll be needing a straw to
eat.

MAX
(showing the middle
finger)
Yeah? Still managed to land more
hits than you.

A car engine is heard humming outside

LIAM
Oh, here comes mommy and daddy with
the rescue fund... not that they've
got much left after last week's
buyout

MISS PEPPER
(taking the ring of her
finger)
Now boys, please behave yourself.
I don't want either of you in more
trouble.

Hurried footsteps outside. HENRY and DANA COHEN enter.
Henry is looking at his smart phone.

DANA COHEN
(in a hurried tone,
gestures towards the boys)
Whatever this is, wrap it up fast. I
can't keep my client waiting all
day.

DANA COHEN (CONT'D)
(looking at Max)
What have you done to yourself!

HENRY COHEN
(looking up from his
phone, concern in his
eyes)
Are you hurt?

MAX
(shrugging)
Its nothing. You didn't have to
come.

HENRY COHEN
(checking Max's faces)
Nothing? Your are bleeding.

MAX
(pushing away from him)
You probably missed some billion
dollar meet for this

HENRY COHEN
(slowly)
I did, and will miss more, if it
means keeping you out of trouble.

MAX
Yeah right, You don't even notice me
half the time.

MISS PEPPER
Mr and Mrs Cohen why don't you have
a seat.

Dana Cohen sits in the chair beside Max, while Miss
Peppers sits opposite. Henry Cohen stands behind Dana.

MISS PEPPER (CONT'D)
I know everyone is in hurry, so I
will try to be fast.

MISS PEPPER (CONT'D)
(in a weary, irritated
tone)
I have to grab my daughter too. My
ex usually does, but.. he is running
late. Again.

DANA COHEN
So what has the boy done now. Honest
to god I am fed up with him. I don't
know how to handle him

DANA COHEN (CONT'D)
(looking at Max)
Look at your clothes. When you wanted them, it was all 'Please, Mom, please!' But now that you have them, you treat them like rags.

MISS PEPPER
(again putting the ring back on her finger)
Miss will you please let me speak.

MISS PEPPER (CONT'D)
There was a disagreement between the boys today. It got physical, but staff stepped in right away, and fortunately no one was seriously hurt.

HENRY COHEN
Ms. Pepper, I trust this unfortunate incident has been handled discreetly. We wouldn't want any unnecessary attention drawn to the school.

LIAM
(holding up his phone)
Don't worry, It's already all over Insta.

MAX
(furiously glancing at Liam, his eyes red)
Asshole. if Lucy hadn't come in between, you would've been in a goddamn stretcher.

DANA COHEN
Max just shut it for once. And Liam I will be talking to your Dad soon.

LIAM
(smugly)
Yeah do that, maybe when you are done sleeping with him.

MAX
(jumping from his, angrily)
Don't you fucking talk to my mother like that.

LIAM (CONT'D)
Everyone at school knows the truth—your dad didn't just sell his company, he sold his wife to us too.

HENRY COHEN

Liam, I suggest you watch your tongue. This has nothing to do with the business. I..

MISS PEPPER

(cutting evryone off, in a loud voice)

Silence both of you, Liam please get out of the room.

LIAM

I ain't going anywhere. You are the one who called me here.

LIAM (CONT'D)

(smirking at MRS COHEN)

and anyway, dad should be here any minute.

DANA COHEN

(flusttered, but angry)

I don't think you are doing a half decent job counselling these brats. I will be taking this up with the principal.

MISS PEPPER

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Ma'am, I do try my level best. But what can you do, when they get away with everything? Their daddy can just buy the school a new gym, and it all disappears.

Henry Cohen's Phone rings. He goes to pick it up.

HENRY COHEN

(phone buzzing, glances down)

Excuse me, I need to—

MAX

(snaps, voice breaking)

Dad, please! For once leave the damned phone.

MAX (CONT'D)

You don't even know what's happening with me. It's always work. Always money. Always you somewhere else.

LIAM

(leans forward, mockingly)

See? The fight, this meeting—it's not about me. You're so busy trying to live up to your dad's big story, to

desperate to show you're not just some spoiled accident. And he-(nods towards Henry) he's trying to prove he's still got what it takes. We all know how much he has to lose.

MAX
(furious, trembling,
pointing at Liam)
Shut up. You don't know a damn thing
about me.

LIAM
(smirks)
I know enough. Everyone does.

MAX
(erupts, voice cracking)
I said shut up!

He shoves the chair back violently, the legs scraping the floor. Miss Pepper reaches out instinctively but Max pulls away.

MISS PEPPER
Max, wait—

MAX
(to all of them, eyes
burning)
You can all go to hell.

Max storms out the room.